

Introduction

We live in a world where our laptops and smartphones act as our consorts and hence the responsibility of their security falls squarely on our shoulders. In the ever-changing world of global data communications, inexpensive internet connections and fast-paced software development, security is becoming more and more of an issue. The situation is compounded by the fact that no computer system can ever be completely secure, as hackers and crackers are coming up with new ways to intercept and alter your data – even as you read this. Another mitigating factor to take into account is that the more secure your system is, the more intrusive your security becomes. You need to decide where, in this balancing act, will your system still be usable, and yet be secure for your purposes. In this Fast Track edition, we'll cover this and much, much more.

Dive with us into the fascinating, albeit treacherous, world of hackers and phishers, and discover what they really are after on your device. The rising popularity of mobile devices has caught the attention of attackers. Discover the top ten threats to mobile devices of which you need to be aware. The diversion of the hacker's attention towards your mobile devices, however, has *not* mitigated the risk to your personal computers. Learn how these threats are no longer restricted to viruses and malware anymore. If you were thinking that we're just going to leave you with dire warnings of threat, hold your horses right there. We bring you the best line of defense available in the market – internet security suite software and reasons why they're so much better than plain ol' anti-virus programs. And finally, we'll give you a plethora of safety tips for all your devices and a number of nifty security apps for your iPhones and Android devices. By the time you're done with this edition of the Fast Track, you'll be aware of the ins and outs of computer and mobile security and ways to stay one step ahead of cyber attackers.

So what are you waiting for? Turn the page and kickstart your induction into the world of security. 